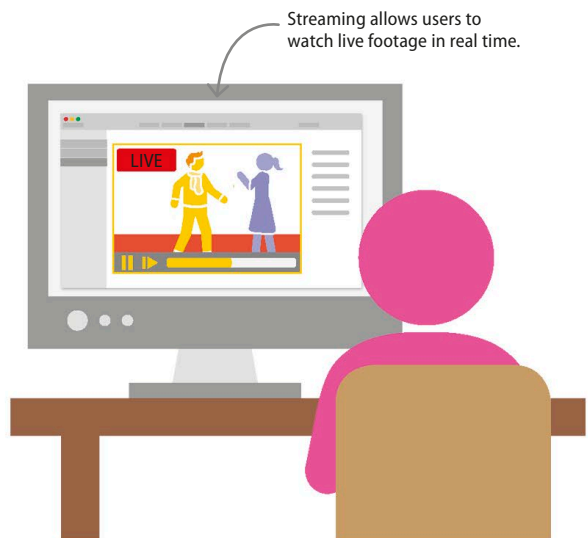


Current streaming techniques

Streaming isn't just used for video or audio. Some gaming systems allow in-home streaming, where audio and video are sent to the player's system, but the game is running on a machine elsewhere. The biggest challenge with streaming is to ensure that no lag is caused by a slow network connection. To address this, many streaming services offer content in different resolutions.

▽ Adjusting the quality

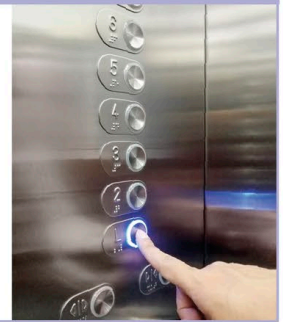
Many modern streaming services use advanced protocols that automatically detect the bandwidth. This allows them to adjust the size and quality of the data being sent.



IN DEPTH

Elevator music

The origins of streaming began with elevator music, also known as Muzak. The creator of Muzak, Major General George O Squier (1865–1934), invented a method to transmit music through electric cables in 1910. He later created a subscription service that let businesses play Muzak's bland, inoffensive background music for a small monthly fee.



Why stream?

As multimedia files get bigger and better, streaming becomes a more logical choice. People who don't want to watch the same video repeatedly need not spend a huge chunk of time and space on a download. That said, streaming can sometimes be more expensive than buying content outright. Also, with streaming, the customer never owns a copy of the content. The table on the right lists some advantages and disadvantages of streaming.

Advantages	Disadvantages
Users don't have to wait for a long download to finish.	A good internet connection is needed throughout the streaming process.
Streaming is especially useful for mobile devices.	To watch a video again, users have to start streaming from scratch.
It helps prevent piracy as there are no files to copy and paste.	It can end up costing more, as it eats up bandwidth.
Content quality can be adapted to the network speed.	If a provider decides to remove content, it can't be accessed again.